

Course Schedule

Weeks 8–13 · Language Models & Transformers

Week	Date	Topics Covered	Textbook	Next Class
Week 8	Mar 25	Introduction to statistical language models, n-gram assumption, smoothing	Introduction to Large Language Models (Chapter 4)	Introduction to Neural Language Models
	Mar 28	Perplexity, Introduction to Neural Language Models — CNN	Introduction to Large Language Models (Chapter 5)	Introduction to Neural Language Models (Contd.)
Week 9	Apr 8	RNN, LSTM, GRU	—	Seq2Seq models, Attention and Self-Attention
	Apr 11	Seq2Seq models and Attention	—	Self-Attention and Intro to Transformer
Week 10	Apr 15	Self-attention and FFN	—	Transformer (contd.)
	Apr 18	Transformer, BERT	—	Pretraining and Finetuning
Week 11	Apr 22	Pre-training and Fine-tuning strategies (BERT, GPT, T5, BART)	—	Instruction Finetuning, Intro to RLHF
	Apr 25	Prompting and advanced prompting	—	Instruction Finetuning, Intro to RLHF
Week 12	—	Break	—	—
Week 13	May 6	Instruction finetuning and intro to RLHF	—	RLHF (contd.)